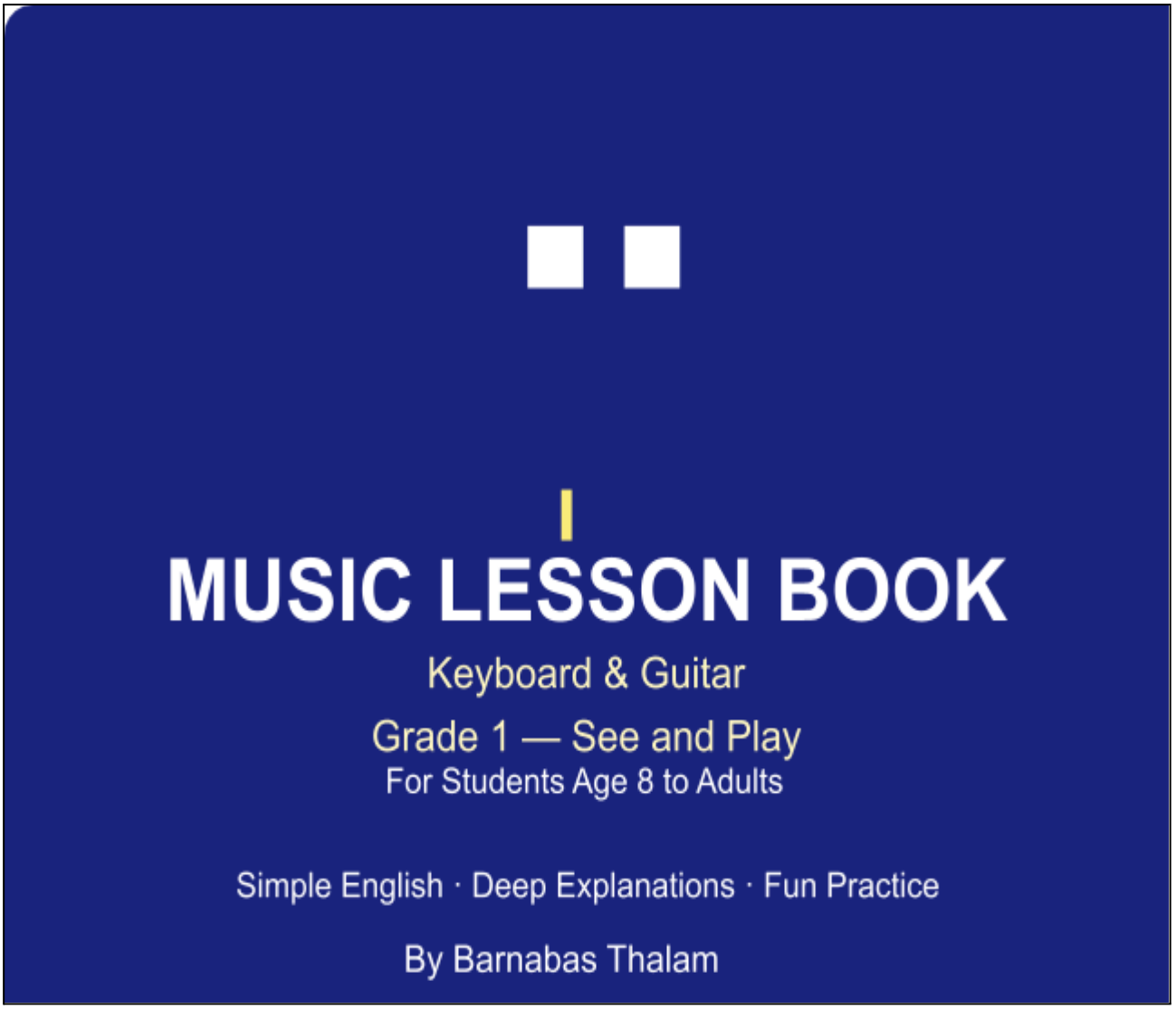


A complete beginner-to-intermediate music course covering Melody, Rhythm, Scales, Chords, and more — written in easy English so every student, from 8 years old to senior adults, can learn and enjoy music.

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HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

Welcome to your music lesson book! This book is written to be very easy to understand, whether you are 8 years old or 80 years old. Each lesson follows the same simple plan:

1. DEFINITION	We explain what the topic is in simple words.
2. DEEP EXPLANATION	We go deeper so you really understand how it works.
3. FORMULA / RULE	We show you the formula or rule and how to use it.
4. EXAMPLES	We give you real musical examples on Keyboard and Guitar.
5. WORKING	We walk through how to apply what you learned step by step.
6. PRACTICE	We give you exercises so you can practice and grow strong.

Golden Rule Always go slowly at first. Music is like learning to walk — one step at a time. Never rush. Repeat each lesson until it feels easy before moving forward.

SECTION 1: MELODY CONCEPT

Melody is the heart of music. It is the part you hum, sing, or whistle. Every song you have ever loved has a melody. In this section, you will learn how melody is made, where notes come from, and how they all connect together.

Lesson 1: Introduction to Music

What is Music?

Music is organised sound. When sounds are put together in a way that feels good to our ears — with a pattern, a beat, and a flow — we call it music. Music can make us happy, sad, excited, or calm. It speaks to our hearts even when words cannot.

The Three Pillars of Music

Every piece of music — whether it is a simple children's song or a grand symphony — is built on three basic pillars:

Pillar	Name	Meaning
1	Melody	The tune — the notes that go up and down to make a song.
2	Rhythm	The beat — the heartbeat of the music that keeps everything in time.
3	Harmony	Chords — notes played together to support the melody.

Keyboard and Guitar — Two Great Instruments

In this course, we learn on two instruments: the **Keyboard** and the **Guitar**. Both instruments can play melody, rhythm, and harmony. Here is how they are different:

Feature	Keyboard	Guitar
How sound is made	Press a key	Pluck or strum a string
Number of notes visible	Many keys, easy to see	6 strings, notes on frets
Good for	Both hands separate	Chords and strumming
Reading music	Treble + Bass clef	Mostly treble clef / tabs

Examples in Real Life

- ■ Keyboard Example: Press the white key called C. That single sound is a note. Play C, E, G together — that is a chord. Play C, D, E, F, G one after another — that is a melody.

- ■ Guitar Example: Pluck the thinnest string open — that note is called E. Now press the 1st fret and pluck — that is F. Two different notes, one after another — that is the start of a melody!

Practice

Practice 1	Sit in front of your keyboard or hold your guitar. Close your eyes and listen to a song you like. Can you hear the melody (the tune)? Can you feel the beat (the rhythm)?
Practice 2	On the keyboard: use one finger to press any five white keys slowly, one after another. Listen to the sound. You just played your first melody!
Practice 3	On the guitar: pluck each of the 6 strings one by one from the thickest to the thinnest. Listen to how each string sounds different — low, medium, and high.
Practice 4	Write down the name of 3 songs you love. Next lesson we will discover what notes those songs use!

Lesson 2: Tones

What is a Tone?

A **tone** is a musical sound that has a clear, steady pitch. Pitch means how high or low a sound is. When you press a key on a keyboard or pluck a string on a guitar, the sound you hear is a tone. Not all sounds are tones — a knock on a door or a clap is a noise, not a tone, because it does not have a steady pitch.

Tones and Half-Tones (Semitones)

In music, the distance between two notes is called an **interval**. The two most important small intervals are:

Name	Also Called	On the Keyboard	On the Guitar
Half Tone	Semitone	Distance from one key to the very next key	Move one fret up/down on the same string
Whole Tone	Tone / Step	Two half-tones together (skip one key)	Move two frets up/ down on the same string

Formula — The Tone Pattern

1 Tone = 2 Half-Tones = 2 Semitones

Think of it like stairs. One half-tone is one small step. One full tone is two small steps. This pattern is very important when we build scales and chords later in this book.

Examples

Keyboard Example — Half Tone: Press the white key C. Now press the very next key to the right, which is the black key C# (C-sharp). That distance is exactly one half-tone (one semitone).

Keyboard Example — Whole Tone: Press C. Skip C# and press the white key D. C to D is one whole tone (two semitones).

Guitar Example — Half Tone: Press the 5th fret on the low E string (thickest). Now move to the 6th fret on the same string. That is one half-tone higher.

Guitar Example — Whole Tone: Press the 5th fret and move to the 7th fret on the same string (skip one fret). That is one whole tone higher.

How Tones Build Melody

A melody moves by tones and half-tones. When notes move by half-tones, the melody sounds smooth and close together. When notes jump by many tones, the melody sounds exciting and dramatic. Composers choose these distances very carefully to make us feel emotions.

■ Did You Know?	The 12 notes in music are each separated by exactly one half-tone from the next. This is why music sounds the same in every country and every language — it is built on this universal mathematical structure.

Practice

Practice 1	Keyboard: Starting from the note C, count and play every single key (white AND black) going right, one by one. Count how many keys it takes to reach the next C. (Answer: 12 half-tones!)
Practice 2	Keyboard: Play C, then D (skip C#). That is a whole tone. Play it 5 times and say 'whole tone' each time.
Practice 3	Guitar: On the 1st string (thinnest), play fret 0 (open), then fret 1, then fret 2. Say 'half-tone, half-tone' as you go. Then play fret 0, then fret 2 and say 'whole tone'.
Practice 4	Listen to the beginning of 'Mary Had a Little Lamb'. Notice how some notes are very close together (half or whole tones) and some jump further apart. Can you feel the difference?

Lesson 3: Sharps and Flats

What are Sharps and Flats?

A **sharp (#)** means to raise a note by one half-tone (one semitone) higher. A **flat (b)** means to lower a note by one half-tone. These symbols are used in music to describe the black keys on a keyboard and to describe notes on the guitar that fall between the natural notes A, B, C, D, E, F, G.

The 12 Notes of Music

There are exactly 12 different notes in Western music. They repeat over and over, going higher and higher (or lower and lower). Here they all are:

Position	Note Name	Keyboard Key	Guitar (String 6, low E)
1	C	White key	8th fret
2	C# / Db	Black key	9th fret
3	D	White key	10th fret
4	D# / Eb	Black key	11th fret
5	E	White key	12th fret
6	F	White key	13th fret (= 1st fret on string 5)
7	F# / Gb	Black key	1st fret on string 5 + 1
8	G	White key	3rd fret on string 6
9	G# / Ab	Black key	4th fret on string 6
10	A	White key	5th fret on string 6
11	A# / Bb	Black key	6th fret on string 6
12	B	White key	7th fret on string 6

Enharmonic Equivalents — Two Names, Same Sound

Notice that the black keys have two names. For example, the black key between C and D is called **C# (C-sharp)** AND **Db (D-flat)**. Both names describe exactly the same sound! We call these **enharmonic equivalents**. Which name we use depends on the key signature of the song.

C# = Db, D# = Eb, F# = Gb, G# = Ab, A# = Bb

How to Find Sharps and Flats on the Guitar

On the guitar, every fret you move UP (towards the guitar body) raises the note by one half-tone (one sharp). Every fret you move DOWN (towards the headstock) lowers the note by one half-tone (one flat).

Formula: Move UP 1 fret = add # (sharp). Move DOWN 1 fret = add b (flat).

Examples

On the keyboard: Press C. Now press the very next black key to the right. That is C# (or Db). They are the same key!

On the guitar: You are playing A on the 5th fret of the low E string. Move to the 6th fret — you are now playing A# (or Bb). Move back to the 4th fret — you are now playing Ab (or G#).

Important! Between E and F there is NO black key, and between B and C there is NO black key. This means E to F is already just one half-tone (even though both are white keys!). Same for B to C. This is one of the most important facts in music theory.

Practice

Practice 1	On the keyboard: Find all 5 black keys in one octave. Name each one using both its sharp name AND its flat name. Example: 'C-sharp, also known as D-flat.'
Practice 2	On the guitar (string 1, thinnest): Start at open E. Play every fret from 0 to 12, naming each note: E, F, F#, G, G#, A, A#, B, C, C#, D, D#, E.
Practice 3	Keyboard challenge: Close your eyes, press any black key. Open your eyes. Can you name it using both sharp and flat names?
Practice 4	Write the 12 notes in order from memory: C, C#, D, D#, E, F, F#, G, G#, A, A#, B. Then write it backwards!

Lesson 4: Octaves — Lower, Middle and Higher

What is an Octave?

The word **octave** comes from the Latin word for 'eight.' An octave is the distance between one note and the next note with the same name — 12 half-tones away. For example, the distance from C to the next C is one octave. The note sounds the same, just higher or lower.

1 Octave = 12 Half-Tones = 8 White Keys (counting start and end)

Lower, Middle, and Higher Octaves

On a standard keyboard, there are usually 7 to 8 octaves. We divide them into three main groups for beginners:

Region	Also Called	Sound Quality	Used For
Lower Octaves	Bass Range	Deep, heavy, rumbling sound	Left hand on keyboard; bass strings on guitar
Middle Octaves	Middle Range	Clear, balanced, easy to hear	Both hands; main melody; guitar strings 2 and 3
Higher Octaves	Treble Range	Bright, light, sparkling sound	Right hand melody; guitar string 1

Middle C — The Most Important Note

Middle C is the C note that sits right in the middle of the keyboard. It is also called **C4** in scientific pitch notation. This is the most important starting point in music because it is right in the centre of the human voice range, and right where the treble clef and bass clef meet on sheet music.

How Octaves Work on Guitar

On the guitar, an octave can be found in a simple pattern. To go one octave higher from any note:

Move 2 strings thinner + move 2 frets higher

Example: C is on the 5th string, 3rd fret. One octave higher C is on the 3rd string, 5th fret. Try it and listen — same note, just higher!

Practice

Practice 1	Keyboard: Find all the C notes on your keyboard. Play them from the lowest C to the highest C one by one. Listen to how each C sounds the same but higher.
Practice 2	Keyboard: Play Middle C with your right hand. Then play the C that is one octave above it, and one octave below it. Compare the three sounds.

Practice 3	Guitar: Find the note A on the 5th fret of the low E string (string 6). Now find A one octave higher using the formula: 2 strings thinner + 2 frets higher = 5th fret of the D string (string 4). Do they sound like the same note, just higher?
Practice 4	Singing challenge: Sing 'Do Re Mi Fa Sol La Ti Do' — the last 'Do' is exactly one octave higher than the first 'Do'. Can you hear and feel it?

Lesson 5: The Importance of 12 Notes

Why Are There Exactly 12 Notes?

In Western music, there are exactly **12 unique notes**. After the 12th note, the pattern repeats one octave higher. These 12 notes are the building blocks of ALL music — every song, every scale, every chord you will ever learn is made from these same 12 notes. This is why learning them is so important!

The 12 Notes: C C# D D# E F F# G G# A A# B (then back to C)

Why 12 Notes Are Powerful

12 Keys	Every note can be the starting point of a scale. So there are 12 major scales and 12 minor scales.
12 x 12 Chords	We can build chords on every note, giving us a huge variety of sounds.
Transposing	Because all 12 notes follow the same pattern, you can move any song to any key.
Universal Language	These 12 notes are used in almost every country in the world — music is a universal language!
Infinite Melodies	With just 12 notes arranged in different orders and rhythms, we can make an unlimited number of songs.

The Pattern of 12 Notes on the Keyboard

Look at the keyboard. You will see a repeating pattern of black keys: 2 black keys, then a gap, then 3 black keys, then a gap — and this repeats all the way. This pattern is your map! The white key just to the LEFT of the group of 2 black keys is always **C**. Once you find C, you can find all 12 notes.

The Pattern of 12 Notes on the Guitar

On the guitar, the 12 notes appear one by one as you move fret by fret. At the **12th fret**, you reach the same note name as the open string, just one octave higher. The fretboard repeats the same 12-note cycle from fret 12 to fret 24.

Guitar Tip The 12th fret on the guitar has dot markers AND a double dot. This marks the octave point — a very important landmark on the fretboard. Single dots mark frets 3, 5, 7, 9 — these are also important position markers.

Working — How to Memorise All 12 Notes

Here is a simple method to memorise all 12 notes using the keyboard black-key pattern as your guide:

- Step 1: Find the group of 2 black keys. The white key to their LEFT is C.
- Step 2: From C, go right: C, C#, D, D#, E, F, F#, G, G#, A, A#, B.
- Step 3: After B, the very next key is C again — a new octave begins.
- Step 4: Say the names out loud as you play each key. Repetition builds memory!
- Step 5: Try it on the guitar — play every fret on one string and name each note.

Practice

Practice 1	Keyboard: Starting from any C, play all 12 notes (including black keys) going right. Name each note aloud. Then play them going left (backwards).
Practice 2	Guitar: On the 6th string (thickest, low E), name every note from fret 0 to fret 12: E, F, F#, G, G#, A, A#, B, C, C#, D, D#, E. Memorise this string — it is the foundation of guitar theory!
Practice 3	Flashcard game: Write each of the 12 note names on small cards. Shuffle them and put them in order as fast as you can.
Practice 4	Creative challenge: Make up a short 4-note tune using only these notes: C, E, G, A. Play it on keyboard or guitar. You just composed your first melody!

SECTION 2: RHYTHM CONCEPT

Rhythm is the heartbeat of music. Without rhythm, music would just be a collection of random sounds. Rhythm tells us WHEN to play each note, how LONG to hold it, and how FAST or SLOW the music moves. In this section you will learn everything about how time works in music.

Lesson 6: Beats

What is a Beat?

A **beat** is the basic unit of time in music. It is the steady pulse you feel when you tap your foot to a song. Beats are like the ticks of a clock — steady, even, and regular. Everything in music happens in relation to the beat.

Strong Beats and Weak Beats

Not all beats feel the same. Some beats are **strong** (heavy, accented) and some are **weak** (light, unaccented). This creates the feeling of the music pushing and pulling, which is what makes us want to dance or nod our heads.

Beat Type	Feel	Example in 4/4 Time
Beat 1	STRONG	The main downbeat — feels like the beginning
Beat 2	Weak	Light, prepares for the next strong beat
Beat 3	Medium Strong	Like a secondary downbeat
Beat 4	Weak	Light, leads back to beat 1

Formula — Counting Beats

Count aloud: 1 — 2 — 3 — 4 — 1 — 2 — 3 — 4 (repeat)

Say '1' loudly and '2, 3, 4' softly. This is the basic counting pattern for 4/4 time (the most common time signature). The number 1 is always the strong beat.

Examples

Clap your hands with this pattern: LOUD-soft-soft-soft | LOUD-soft-soft-soft. That is 4/4 time.
Now try: LOUD-soft-soft | LOUD-soft-soft. That is 3/4 time (waltz time — like a lullaby).

Practice

Practice 1	Clap a steady beat for 30 seconds without stopping. Say '1-2-3-4' out loud with each clap. Make beat 1 louder.

Practice 2	Keyboard: Press any one key on every beat (1-2-3-4). Keep it steady and even. Use a timer on your phone — try to keep the same speed for 1 minute.
Practice 3	Guitar: Strum one chord (any chord) on every beat. Count 1-2-3-4 aloud as you strum. Keep going for 1 minute.
Practice 4	Listen to a song and tap your finger on the table to the beat. Count 1-2-3-4 in your head. Can you feel where beat 1 is? (It usually feels like the 'start' of the pattern.)

Lesson 7: Timing

What is Timing in Music?

Timing means playing the right note at exactly the right moment. Good timing is what makes music sound professional and clean. Bad timing is when notes are played too early or too late, making the music sound sloppy or confused.

Time Signatures

A **time signature** tells you how many beats are in each bar (also called a measure) and what kind of note gets one beat. It looks like a fraction at the start of a piece of music:

Time Signature	Top Number Means	Bottom Number Means	Feel
4/4	4 beats per bar	Quarter note = 1 beat	Most common; march, pop, rock
3/4	3 beats per bar	Quarter note = 1 beat	Waltz; lullaby; graceful
2/4	2 beats per bar	Quarter note = 1 beat	March; quick and sharp
6/8	6 beats per bar	Eighth note = 1 beat	Lilting; flowing; feels like 2 groups of 3

Note Values and Their Timing

Different notes last for different amounts of time. Here are the most common note values in 4/4 time:

Note Name	Symbol Name	Beats Held	Think of It As
Whole Note	Semibreve	4 beats	Hold for the entire bar
Half Note	Minim	2 beats	Hold for half the bar
Quarter Note	Crotchet	1 beat	One foot-tap
Eighth Note	Quaver	1/2 beat	Two in one foot-tap
Sixteenth Note	Semiquaver	1/4 beat	Four in one foot-tap

Formula — How to Count Notes

Quarter Note: say '1' | Half Note: say '1 — 2' | Whole Note: say '1 — 2 — 3 — 4'
Eighth Note: say '1 and' (the 'and' falls between the beats)

Practice

Practice 1	Clap: 4 quarter notes (1-2-3-4), then 2 half notes (1-hold-3-hold), then 1 whole note (1-hold-hold-hold). Repeat the pattern 4 times.
Practice 2	Keyboard: In 4/4 time, play C for 4 beats (whole note), then play D for 2 beats and E for 2 beats (half notes), then play F-G-A-B each for 1 beat (quarter notes). Keep the beat steady!

Practice 3	Guitar: Strum one chord 4 times (quarter notes). Then strum once and hold for 4 beats (whole note). Alternate between the two for 2 minutes.
Practice 4	Count and clap: '1 and 2 and 3 and 4 and' (the 'and' is an eighth note). This gives you 8 claps per bar — try it slowly first.

Lesson 8: Style

What is Musical Style?

Style in music refers to the way music is played — the feel, the energy, and the character. Two musicians can play the exact same notes but sound completely different because of their style. Style includes: how you touch the keys or strings, whether you play smoothly or sharply, fast or slow, and what kind of rhythm patterns you use.

Common Musical Styles

Style	Character	Keyboard Feel	Guitar Feel
Classical	Formal, precise, elegant	Clean fingering, strict timing	Fingerpicking, classical posture
Pop	Catchy, upbeat, simple	Chords + melody, smooth	Strumming, power chords
Jazz	Swinging, improvised, relaxed	Syncopated chords, swing feel	Jazzy chord voicings
Blues	Soulful, expressive, bending	12-bar pattern, bluesy notes	String bends, slides
Gospel	Powerful, spiritual, rhythmi	Rich chords, strong beat	Rhythm strumming, strong chords
Waltz	Graceful, 3-beat flow	1-bass + 2-chord + 3-chord	Boom-chick-chick pattern
March	Strong, military, steady	Crisp, even, 2/4 time	Precise, punchy strums

How Style Changes the Same Notes

Let's say you play C-D-E-F-G five times. Now change the style:

- Classical: Play each note perfectly even, smooth, no rushing. • Jazz: Swing the rhythm — make notes uneven (long-short-long-short). • Blues: Play slower, maybe bend one note slightly. • Pop: Play it cheerfully with a bouncy beat. Same notes — completely different feelings!

Practice

Practice 1	Play a simple 5-note scale (C D E F G) in classical style — slow, smooth, even. Then play the same 5 notes in a bouncy, fast pop style. Hear the difference!
Practice 2	Keyboard: Play 4-beat chords in waltz style: play a bass note on beat 1, then a chord on beats 2 and 3 (in 3/4 time). Feel the 1-2-3 waltz swing.
Practice 3	Guitar: Strum a chord in march style (crisp and sharp on every beat). Then strum the same chord in a slow, flowing style. Notice how your wrist and arm movement changes.

Practice 4	Listen to 3 different songs from 3 different styles (e.g., a classical piece, a pop song, and a blues song). Write down 2 words to describe each style.

Lesson 9: Tempo

What is Tempo?

Tempo is the speed of the music — how fast or slow the beats go. The word 'tempo' comes from Italian (many music terms are in Italian because Italy was the centre of music in Europe for hundreds of years). Tempo is measured in **BPM — Beats Per Minute**. This tells you how many beats happen in one minute of time.

BPM = number of beats that happen in 60 seconds

Tempo Markings and Their Speeds

Italian Term	Meaning	BPM Range	Example Song Style
Grave	Very slow and serious	20–40 BPM	Funeral march, very serious pieces
Largo	Broad and slow	40–60 BPM	Slow hymns, ballads
Adagio	Slow and stately	60–70 BPM	Slow romantic songs
Andante	Walking pace	70–80 BPM	Walking, flowing melodies
Moderato	Moderate speed	80–100 BPM	Most pop songs, folk songs
Allegro	Fast and lively	100–140 BPM	Upbeat pop, dance songs
Presto	Very fast	140–180 BPM	Fast classical pieces, energetic music
Prestissimo	Extremely fast	180+ BPM	Racing, very advanced pieces

■ Golden Rule of Tempo

Always learn new songs SLOWLY first (Largo or Adagio speed), even if the song is meant to be fast. Only speed up when your fingers know exactly where to go. A song learned slowly and correctly is much easier to speed up than one learned with mistakes.

Practice

Practice 1	Tap your finger on the table exactly 60 times in one minute (use a phone timer). That is 60 BPM. Now try tapping twice as fast (120 BPM). Feel the difference?
Practice 2	Play a simple scale (C D E F G A B C) at a slow speed. Then play it faster. Then faster again. Notice how your accuracy changes. Always slow down if you make mistakes.
Practice 3	Use a free metronome app (many are available) or the built-in one on your keyboard. Set it to 80 BPM and clap along. Then try 120 BPM. Then 60 BPM.

Practice 4	Listen to a slow song and a fast song. Tap the beat for each. Count how many taps you make in 15 seconds, then multiply by 4. That gives you the approximate BPM!

Lesson 10: Metronome

What is a Metronome?

A **metronome** is a device (or app) that produces a steady click or beep at a set tempo. It is the musician's best friend because it helps you keep perfect time while you practice. Even the greatest musicians in the world use a metronome every single day.

Why Use a Metronome?

When we play music, our natural tendency is to rush when things are easy and slow down when things are hard. This makes the music sound uneven and unprofessional. A metronome fixes this by giving you a constant, unchanging beat that you must follow.

How to Use a Metronome — Step by Step

- Step 1: Set the metronome to a SLOW tempo (60–70 BPM to start).
- Step 2: Listen to the click for a few seconds before you start playing.
- Step 3: Start playing your exercise or song exactly on the click — not before, not after.
- Step 4: Keep playing while the metronome clicks. Every note should land on (or between) a click.
- Step 5: If you make a mistake, DON'T stop. Keep going with the metronome.
- Step 6: Once you can play correctly at slow speed 3 times in a row, increase the BPM by 5.
- Step 7: Repeat until you reach the target speed of the song.

Types of Metronomes

Mechanical Metronome	A pendulum device with a clicking arm. Wind it up and it ticks.
Electronic Metronome	A small digital device with a beeping sound and visual flash.
Built-in Keyboard Metronome	Most keyboards have a built-in metronome button. Check your manual!
Metronome App	Free apps like 'Pro Metronome' or 'GuitarTuna' have metronomes. Very convenient!

Practice

Practice 1	Set metronome to 60 BPM. Clap on every click. Do this for 2 minutes without losing the beat.
Practice 2	Keyboard: Set metronome to 70 BPM. Play C-D-E-F-G-F-E-D-C (one note per click). Keep going for 2 minutes.

Practice 3	Guitar: Set metronome to 70 BPM. Strum any chord once per click. After 1 minute, try strumming twice per click (eighth notes).
Practice 4	Challenge: Set metronome to 100 BPM. Clap on every OTHER click (beats 2 and 4 only). This is called the 'backbeat' and is very important in pop music!

Lesson 11: Starts and Ends

How Songs Begin and End

Every song has a clear start and a clear end. Knowing how to start a song properly (in time, with confidence) and how to end it (cleanly, with the right final note or chord) is an important skill that makes you sound like a real musician.

Types of Starts

Type of Start	What It Means	Example
Downbeat Start	Song begins on Beat 1	Most songs — you count '1-2-3-4' and start on '1'
Anacrusis (Pickup)	Song starts on a beat BEFORE Beat 1	'Happy Birthday' - the word 'Hap-' comes before beat 1
Intro Start	Introduction plays before main melody	Many pop songs have 4-bar or 8-bar intro before singing starts

Types of Endings (Cadences)

An ending in music is called a **cadence**. Different cadences give different feelings:

Cadence Type	How It Sounds	Common Use
Perfect (Full) Cadence	V chord → I chord. Sounds complete and final.	Last bar of most songs
Plagal Cadence	IV chord → I chord. Sounds like 'Amen' in church.	Hymns, gospel, endings
Imperfect Cadence	I chord → V chord. Sounds unfinished, like ques.	Ends a verse, leads to chorus
Interrupted Cadence	V chord → VI chord. Surprise ending!	Dramatic moments, surprises

Practice

Practice 1	Sing 'Happy Birthday' — notice how it starts on the word 'Hap-' BEFORE beat 1. That is an anacrusis (pickup). Try playing it on keyboard or guitar.
Practice 2	Keyboard: Play any simple song and focus on starting EXACTLY on beat 1 of the metronome. Count '1-2-3-4' in your head before starting.
Practice 3	Play a scale ending on the note C and hold it for 4 beats. That is a simple 'final ending.' Try it — it feels complete and finished.
Practice 4	Listen to 3 songs. Notice if the ending sounds complete (the song 'lands') or open/questioning (the song feels unresolved).

Lesson 12: Notes and Beats

The Relationship Between Notes and Beats

Every note has two properties: its **pitch** (how high or low it is) and its **duration** (how long it lasts). The duration of a note is measured in beats. This lesson teaches you how to combine these two things to read and play music correctly.

The Note Value Chart

Note Type	Duration	Count As
Whole Note	4 beats	1 - 2 - 3 - 4
Dotted Half Note	3 beats	1 - 2 - 3
Half Note	2 beats	1 - 2
Quarter Note	1 beat	1
Eighth Note	1/2 beat	1 and
Sixteenth Note	1/4 beat	1 e and a
Triplet	3 notes in 1 beat	1 trip let

How Dots Affect Note Duration

A dot placed after a note adds HALF of that note's value to it.

Dotted Quarter Note = 1 beat + 1/2 beat = 1.5 beats Dotted Half Note = 2 beats + 1 beat = 3 beats Dotted Whole Note = 4 beats + 2 beats = 6 beats

Working — Combining Notes in a Bar

In 4/4 time, every bar must add up to exactly 4 beats. Let's check some combinations:

Combination	Beat Count	Total	Valid?
Whole note	4 beats	4 beats	YES
2 half notes	2 + 2	4 beats	YES
4 quarter notes	1+1+1+1	4 beats	YES
1 half + 2 quarters	2+1+1	4 beats	YES
3 quarter notes	1+1+1	3 beats	NO — missing 1 beat

Practice

Practice 1	Clap and count this rhythm: Quarter, Quarter, Half Note (1, 2, 3-hold). Repeat 4 times. This is a very common rhythm in songs!

Practice 2	Keyboard: Play C (quarter), D (quarter), E (half) — 4 beats total. Then: C (whole note) — 4 beats. Then: E-F-G-A each as quarter notes — 4 beats. You just played 3 bars!
Practice 3	Guitar: Strum the pattern: DOWN (1) DOWN (2) DOWN-hold (3-4). That is a bar of 4/4 with quarter-quarter-half. Repeat for 2 minutes.
Practice 4	Fill in the blanks: In 4/4 time, if I have a half note and a quarter note, I need ____more beats to complete the bar. What note could fill it?

Lesson 13: Rolling A & B

What is Rolling in Music?

Rolling is a technique used in keyboard and guitar playing where you play a series of notes in quick, smooth succession — like a gentle wave or a rolling motion. It creates a beautiful flowing sound instead of all notes being played at exactly the same moment.

Rolling Pattern A

Rolling A is an ascending roll — you play notes from LOW to HIGH in a quick, smooth sequence. Think of it as rolling from the bottom of a chord upwards, like water flowing uphill.

Pattern A: Low → Mid → High (Bottom to Top)

Keyboard Example: For a C major chord (C-E-G), play C first, then E just a tiny moment after, then G just a tiny moment after that. The three notes blur together into one beautiful sound that rolls upward.

Guitar Example: Strum the chord from the 6th string (lowest) to the 1st string (highest) in one smooth downward arm motion. Each string sounds just after the previous one — that IS a guitar roll!

Rolling Pattern B

Rolling B is a descending roll — you play notes from HIGH to LOW in a quick, smooth sequence. This creates a sense of falling or resolution.

Pattern B: High → Mid → Low (Top to Bottom)

Keyboard Example: For C major (C-E-G), play G first, then E, then C. The sound cascades downward like a waterfall.

Guitar Example: Strum from string 1 (thinnest) upward to string 6 (thickest) in one smooth upward strumming motion.

Where Rolls Are Used

Song Intros	A rolled chord at the start of a song sounds dramatic and beautiful.
Accompaniment	Rolling chords in the left hand on keyboard while right hand plays melody.
Guitar Arpeggios	Playing each string of a chord separately — this is the guitar version of rolling.

Ending a Song	A final rolled chord at the end of a performance sounds very professional.
Gospel & Hymns	Rolling chords are very common in church music and gospel playing.

Practice

Practice 1	Keyboard: Hold down C-E-G (C major chord) with your right hand. Now play them one at a time from bottom to top very quickly — C, E, G — in one smooth motion (Roll A). Repeat 10 times.
Practice 2	Keyboard: Now play Roll B — G, E, C from top to bottom quickly. Repeat 10 times. Then alternate: Roll A, Roll B, Roll A, Roll B.
Practice 3	Guitar: Place fingers for a G chord. Strum slowly from string 6 to string 1, listening to each string sound just after the previous (Roll A). Then strum from string 1 to string 6 (Roll B).
Practice 4	Creative exercise: Play Roll A on a C chord, then Roll A on an F chord, then Roll A on a G chord, then Roll B on a C chord. That is a complete musical phrase using rolls!

SECTION 3: SCALES CONCEPT

Scales are the foundation of all music. If you understand scales, you understand where melodies come from, why chords work the way they do, and how to find the right notes for any song. This section will give you a deep understanding of major and minor scales.

Lesson 14: Definition of Scales

What is a Scale?

A **scale** is a set of notes arranged in a specific order of tones (T) and half-tones (H) going from one note to the same note one octave higher. The word 'scale' comes from the Latin word 'scala' meaning 'ladder' — and that is exactly what a scale is: a musical ladder you climb up or down.

Why Scales Matter

Melodies	Almost every melody is built from the notes of a scale.
Chords	Chords are built using notes from scales (1st, 3rd, 5th degree).
Key Signatures	A scale defines the 'key' of a song — which notes are used.
Improvisation	When you improvise (make up music on the spot), you use scale notes.
Transposing	Scales help you move a song to a different key easily.
Ear Training	Practicing scales trains your ear to hear music more clearly.

The Degrees of a Scale

Each note in a scale has a number called a **degree**. The degrees tell us the position of each note within the scale:

Degree	Number	Name	Role
1st	I	Tonic	Home base — the most stable note
2nd	II	Supertonic	One step above home
3rd	III	Mediant	Defines major or minor character
4th	IV	Subdominant	Creates tension, movement
5th	V	Dominant	The second most important — creates strong pull back to home
6th	VI	Submediant	Important for minor chords
7th	VII	Leading Tone	Creates strong desire to resolve to the tonic
8th	VIII (I)	Octave	Same as the 1st degree, one octave higher

Practice

Practice 1	On your keyboard: Find C, then count up the white keys: C(1), D(2), E(3), F(4), G(5), A(6), B(7), C(8). Say the degree number as you play each note.
Practice 2	Sing 'Do-Re-Mi-Fa-Sol-La-Ti-Do' — this is a major scale! The syllables match the 8 degrees of the scale.
Practice 3	On guitar: On string 1 (thinnest, open E), play every note of the E major scale using these frets: 0-2-4-5-7-9-11-12. Say the degree numbers.
Practice 4	Write the degrees 1 through 8 on paper, then write which note they correspond to in the C major scale next to each number.

Lesson 15: Function of Major Scales

What Makes a Scale 'Major'?

A **major scale** has a bright, happy, and confident sound. It uses a specific pattern of tones (T) and half-tones (H) that NEVER changes, no matter what note you start on. This pattern is the formula for every major scale in music.

Major Scale Formula: T – T – H – T – T – T – H (T = Whole Tone = 2 frets / 2 keys) (H = Half Tone = 1 fret / 1 key) 1 3 5 6 8 10 12 13 (Cut : 2 4 7 9 11)

Building the C Major Scale

Let's apply the formula starting from C:

Step	From	Move	To	Note
1	C	T (2 half-tones)	D	D
2	D	T (2 half-tones)	E	E
3	E	H (1 half-tone)	F	F
4	F	T (2 half-tones)	G	G
5	G	T (2 half-tones)	A	A
6	A	T (2 half-tones)	B	B
7	B	H (1 half-tone)	C	C (octave)

Result: C Major Scale = C D E F G A B C

All 12 Major Scales

Key	Scale Notes
C Major	C – D – E – F – G – A – B – C
G Major	G – A – B – C – D – E – F# – G
D Major	D – E – F# – G – A – B – C# – D
A Major	A – B – C# – D – E – F# – G# – A
E Major	E – F# – G# – A – B – C# – D# – E
B Major	B – C# – D# – E – F# – G# – A# – B
F# Major	F# – G# – A# – B – C# – D# – E# – F#
F Major	F – G – A – Bb – C – D – E – F
Bb Major	Bb – C – D – Eb – F – G – A – Bb
Eb Major	Eb – F – G – Ab – Bb – C – D – Eb
Ab Major	Ab – Bb – C – Db – Eb – F – G – Ab
Db Major	Db – Eb – F – Gb – Ab – Bb – C – Db

Practice

Practice 1	Keyboard: Play the C Major scale (C D E F G A B C) going up and down. Say each note name aloud. Repeat 5 times. The C major scale uses ONLY white keys — the easiest to see!
Practice 2	Apply the formula: Start on G. Use T-T-H-T-T-T-H to build the G major scale. You should get G-A-B-C-D-E-F#-G. Check it!
Practice 3	Guitar (6th string method): Play the A major scale starting at the 5th fret. Fret positions: 5-7-9-10-12-14-16-17. Name the notes: A-B-C#-D-E-F#-G#-A.
Practice 4	Memory challenge: Without looking, write down the C major scale and the G major scale from memory. Check your work against the table above.

Lesson 16: Function of Minor Scales

What Makes a Scale 'Minor'?

A **minor scale** has a darker, sadder, and more mysterious sound compared to a major scale. The difference comes from the pattern of tones and half-tones. The most important difference: the **3rd note** in a minor scale is one half-tone LOWER than in a major scale. This small change creates a completely different emotion!

Natural Minor Scale Formula: T – H – T – T – H – T – T / 1 3 4 6 8 9 11 13 (Cut : 2 5 7 10 12)

Building the A Minor Scale

Let's apply the minor formula starting from A:

Step	From	Move	To	Note
1	A	T	B	B
2	B	H	C	C
3	C	T	D	D
4	D	T	E	E
5	E	H	F	F
6	F	T	G	G
7	G	T	A	A (octave)

Result: A Minor Scale = A B C D E F G A

Three Types of Minor Scales

Type	Pattern	Character	Common Use
Natural Minor	T-H-T-T-H-T-T	Sad, dark, flowing	Classical, folk, pop ballads
Harmonic Minor	T-H-T-T-H-3H-H (raised 7th)	Exotic, dramatic, Middle-Eastern	Classical harmony, dramatic
Melodic Minor	Different going up and down	Smooth but with drama	Classical melodies, jazz

Major vs Minor — The Feeling Difference

Play C major (C-D-E-F-G-A-B-C). Notice how bright and happy it sounds. Now play C minor (C-D-Eb-F-G-Ab-Bb-C). Notice the darker, more emotional feeling. The difference is just 3 notes (3rd, 6th, 7th are lowered by one half-tone each)!

Practice

Practice 1	Keyboard: Play A minor scale (A B C D E F G A) — it uses ONLY white keys, just like C major! But it starts on A. Play it up and down 5 times.

Practice 2	Apply the minor formula: Start on E. Use T-H-T-T-H-T-T. You should get E-F#-G-A-B-C-D-E (E natural minor). Check it!
Practice 3	Comparison exercise: Play C major, then C minor, back and forth. Listen carefully to the difference in mood. Describe in one word how each one makes you feel.
Practice 4	Guitar: Find the E minor scale starting on the open 6th string: 0-2-3-5-7-8-10-12. Name the notes: E-F#-G-A-B-C-D-E.

Lesson 17: Finding Major Scales in a Song

How to Identify the Major Scale of a Song

Every song is written in a **key**. The key tells you which scale the song is based on. When a song is in a major key, most of its notes come from that major scale. Learning to identify the key of a song is an essential skill for any musician.

Method 1 — Listen for the 'Home' Note

The home note (tonic) is the note the song keeps returning to — especially at the end of phrases and at the very end of the song. This note is usually the first note of the scale the song uses.

Method 2 — Count the Sharps and Flats

Written music uses a **key signature** at the start — this tells you how many sharps (#) or flats (b) are in the scale. Use this chart:

Sharps/Flats	Number	Major Key
No sharps or flats	0	C Major
1 sharp (F#)	1#	G Major
2 sharps (F#, C#)	2#	D Major
3 sharps (F#, C#, G#)	3#	A Major
1 flat (Bb)	1b	F Major
2 flats (Bb, Eb)	2b	Bb Major
3 flats (Bb, Eb, Ab)	3b	Eb Major

Method 3 — Find the Scale on the Keyboard/Guitar

- Step 1: Listen to the song and hum the melody.
- Step 2: Find the starting note of the melody on your instrument.
- Step 3: Try playing the major scale starting from that note.
- Step 4: If the scale notes match the song's melody, you found the key!
- Step 5: If it sounds wrong, try a different starting note.

Example — 'Happy Birthday'

> Happy Birthday is most commonly played in C major. The notes used are mostly C, D, E, F, G, A — all from the C major scale. The 'home' note is C (the song resolves to C). The key signature has no sharps or flats — confirming C major!

Practice

Practice 1	Take any 3 songs you know. Hum them and try to find the starting note on your keyboard or guitar. Is that note the home note?
Practice 2	Keyboard: Play 'Mary Had a Little Lamb' (E-D-C-D-E-E-E-D-D-D-E-G-G). Which note does it keep coming back to? What major scale does it use?
Practice 3	Look at a piece of printed sheet music. Count the sharps or flats in the key signature at the beginning. Use the chart above to identify the key.
Practice 4	Play the C major scale, then play a simple improvised melody using ONLY those 8 notes. Your melody will automatically sound 'in key'!

Lesson 18: Finding Minor Scales in a Song

How Songs in Minor Keys Feel

Songs in minor keys feel darker, sadder, more serious or mysterious. Many beautiful ballads, classical pieces, and emotional songs are in minor keys. Learning to identify minor keys opens up a whole new world of music for you.

Relative Major and Minor — An Important Relationship

Every major scale has a **relative minor** — a minor scale that uses EXACTLY the same notes. The relative minor starts on the **6th degree** of the major scale.

Formula: Relative Minor = Start on the 6th note of the Major Scale

Major Key	Relative Minor Key	Shared Notes
C Major	A Minor	C D E F G A B
G Major	E Minor	G A B C D E F#
D Major	B Minor	D E F# G A B C#
F Major	D Minor	F G A Bb C D E
Bb Major	G Minor	Bb C D Eb F G A

How to Tell Major from Minor When Listening

Feeling	Happy, bright, confident = likely Major | Sad, dark, mysterious = likely Minor
Last Chord	Songs almost always end on their 'home' chord. If it sounds minor, the song is in a minor key.
The 3rd Note	Play the scale note by note. If the 3rd note sounds 'low' (dark), it is minor. If it sounds 'bright', it is major.

Practice

Practice 1	Play A minor scale (A B C D E F G A). Play C major scale (C D E F G A B C). Notice they use the same notes but start on different notes. Play both and hear the difference!
Practice 2	Listen to 5 songs. For each one, decide: does it feel happy (major) or sad/dark (minor)? Write your answers.

Practice 3	Keyboard: Play just the notes C-E-G (C major chord). Then play C-Eb-G (C minor chord). Notice how the Eb (instead of E) changes the whole mood.
Practice 4	Find the relative minor of G major: count up 6 notes in G major: G(1)-A(2)-B(3)-C(4)-D(5)-E(6). The relative minor is E minor!

Lesson 19: Importance of Transposing

What is Transposing?

Transposing means moving a song from one key to another key, keeping all the intervals (the distances between notes) exactly the same. The melody stays the same — it just starts on a different note and all the other notes move by the same amount.

Why Transposing is Important

For Singers	Every singer has a comfortable vocal range. Transposing moves the song to the right key for their voice.
For Instruments	Some instruments have different ranges. Transposing makes a song playable on different instruments.
For Comfort	Some keys are easier to play on keyboard (like C major). Others are easier on guitar (like E or G major).
Creativity	Transposing helps you understand how music works and makes you a better musician.
Accompanying Others	If someone sings in a different key than written, you need to transpose to match them.

How to Transpose — Step by Step

- Step 1: Know the original key of the song (e.g., C major).
- Step 2: Know the new key you want to play in (e.g., G major).
- Step 3: Count how many half-tones apart the two keys are (C to G = 7 half-tones UP).
- Step 4: Move EVERY note in the song up by that same number of half-tones (7 half-tones).
- Step 5: The melody shape and feel stays the same — just higher (or lower).

Example — Transposing 'Mary Had a Little Lamb'

Original in C major: E-D-C-D-E-E-E | D-D-D | E-G-G Transposed to G major (move everything up 7 half-tones): B-A-G-A-B-B-B | A-A-A | B-D-D The melody sounds identical — just higher!

Transposing on Guitar — Using a Capo

A **capo** is a simple clamp that goes across the guitar strings at any fret. When you put a capo on fret 2, all your chords go UP by 2 half-tones automatically! This is the easiest way to transpose on guitar — no need to learn new chord shapes.

Capo on Fret 1 = all chords go UP 1 half-tone Capo on Fret 2 = all chords go UP 2 half-tones (1 whole tone) Capo on Fret 5 = all chords go UP 5 half-tones

Practice

Practice 1	Keyboard: Play 'Mary Had a Little Lamb' in C major (E-D-C-D-E-E-E). Then move ALL the notes up 2 half-tones and play it in D major. Does it sound the same but higher?
Practice 2	Play the C major scale. Now play the same scale pattern starting on G (G major scale). You just transposed a scale!
Practice 3	Guitar capo exercise: Play a simple chord (like G major) without a capo. Then put the capo on fret 2 and play the same G major shape. Listen — it now sounds like an A major chord!
Practice 4	Real life challenge: Find a song that is too high for a singer to sing comfortably. Try playing it 2 or 3 half-tones lower. Does it fit their voice better?

Lesson 20: Review and Application of Scales

Putting It All Together

In this lesson, we bring together everything you have learned about scales. This is your review and practical application session. By the end of this lesson, you should be able to build any major or minor scale, identify them in songs, and understand how to use them musically.

Scale Review Summary

Concept	Formula / Key Fact
Major Scale	T-T-H-T-T-T-H — Bright, happy sound
Natural Minor Scale	T-H-T-T-H-T-T — Dark, sad sound
Relative Minor	Start on the 6th note of the major scale
Octave	12 half-tones — same note, different height
Transposing	Move all notes by the same interval to a new key
Key Signature	Sharps/flats tell you which major (or relative minor) key
Scale Degrees	1=Tonic, 3=Mediant, 5=Dominant are most important

Application Exercise — Build and Play

For each of the following keys, (a) write out the scale notes, (b) play the scale on your instrument, (c) identify a song you know that uses that scale:

Key to Work With	Write the Scale Notes	Song That Uses This Key
C Major		Mary Had a Little Lamb, Happy Birthday
G Major		Ode to Joy (in G), many folk songs
A Minor		Greensleeves, House of the Rising Sun
E Minor		Hotel California intro, many classical pieces
D Major		Country roads (often), many hymns

Final Scale Practice for Section 3

Practice 1	Play all 12 major scales starting from C and going through the circle of fifths: C-G-D-A-E-B-F#-Db-Ab-Eb-Bb-F. This is a lifelong daily practice exercise!
Practice 2	Play all 12 natural minor scales. Start with A minor, E minor, B minor, F# minor, etc.

Practice 3	Guitar: Learn to play the major scale pattern starting from any root note on the 6th string using this fret pattern: Root, R+2, R+4, R+5, R+7, R+9, R+11, R+12.
Practice 4	Compose a short 8-bar melody using ONLY the notes of C major. Play it with one hand on keyboard or on guitar. You just wrote a real piece of music!

SECTION 4: CHORDS CONCEPT

Chords are the harmony of music. When you play two or more notes at the same time that sound good together, you are playing a chord. Chords give a melody its emotional colour and provide the musical background (accompaniment) for singing or soloing. In this section you will learn how to build and use chords confidently.

Lesson 21: Definition of Chords

What is a Chord?

A **chord** is three or more notes played at the same time that create a harmonious sound. The simplest and most important chord is the **triad** — a three-note chord built by stacking notes in a specific pattern. Almost every song you will ever play uses triads as its basic chords.

How Chords Relate to Scales

Chords are built from scales. You pick a note from the scale (the root), then add the 3rd note of the scale, then the 5th note of the scale. This gives you a triad. For example, in C major scale (C-D-E-F-G-A-B):

C Major Chord = C (1st) + E (3rd) + G (5th) = C – E – G

Types of Chords You Will Learn

Chord Type	Formula	Sound Quality	Symbol
Major Triad	Root + Major 3rd + Perfect 5th	Happy, bright, strong	C, G, Am (no 'm')
Minor Triad	Root + Minor 3rd + Perfect 5th	Sad, dark, emotional	Cm, Am, Em (with 'm')
Dominant 7th	Major Triad + Minor 7th	Bluesy, tense, wants to resolve	C7, G7
Major 7th	Major Triad + Major 7th	Beautiful, romantic, jazzy	Cmaj7
Suspended (Sus)	Replace 3rd with 4th or 2nd	Open, floating, unresolved	Csus4, Csus2

Chord Progressions — How Chords Move

A **chord progression** is a series of chords played one after another. Most songs use the same 3 or 4 chords repeated in a pattern. The most common progression in all of pop music is:

I – V – VI – IV (in C major: C – G – Am – F)

> Hundreds of famous songs use this exact progression, including 'Let It Be', 'No Woman No Cry', 'Someone Like You', and many more!

Practice

Practice 1	Keyboard: Press C, E, and G all at the same time with your right hand (thumb on C, middle finger on E, pinky on G). Hold for 4 beats. You just played your first chord!
Practice 2	Guitar: Learn the C major chord (x32010). Press the frets, strum all 6 strings. Listen for a clear sound — all notes should ring!
Practice 3	Keyboard: Play C major (C-E-G), then G major (G-B-D), then A minor (A-C-E), then F major (F-A-C). That is the famous I-V-VI-IV progression!
Practice 4	Identify chords in a song: Listen to any pop song and count how many different chords you hear. Most use between 2 and 4 different chords.

Lesson 22: Formatting the Major Chords

The Major Chord Formula

Every major chord is built using the same interval formula, regardless of which note you start on:

Major Chord = Root + 4 half-tones up + 3 half-tones up (Root) (Major 3rd) (Perfect 5th)

All 12 Major Chords

Chord	Root	Major 3rd	Perfect 5th	Notes
C Major	C	E (4 H up)	G (7 H up)	C – E – G
C# / Db Major	C#	F (4 H up)	G# (7 H up)	C# – F – G#
D Major	D	F# (4 H up)	A (7 H up)	D – F# – A
D# / Eb Major	D#	G (4 H up)	A# (7 H up)	D# – G – A#
E Major	E	G# (4 H up)	B (7 H up)	E – G# – B
F Major	F	A (4 H up)	C (7 H up)	F – A – C
F# / Gb Major	F#	A# (4 H up)	C# (7 H up)	F# – A# – C#
G Major	G	B (4 H up)	D (7 H up)	G – B – D
G# / Ab Major	G#	C (4 H up)	D# (7 H up)	G# – C – D#
A Major	A	C# (4 H up)	E (7 H up)	A – C# – E
A# / Bb Major	A#	D (4 H up)	F (7 H up)	A# – D – F
B Major	B	D# (4 H up)	F# (7 H up)	B – D# – F#

Guitar Open Chord Shapes (Must-Know)

Chord	Finger Positions (String 6-5-4-3-2-1)	Tips
E Major	0-2-2-1-0-0	Open strings ring beautifully
A Major	x-0-2-2-2-0	Keep 3 fingers close together
D Major	x-x-0-2-3-2	3 fingers on 3 strings
G Major	3-2-0-0-0-3	Can also use 3-2-0-0-3-3
C Major	x-3-2-0-1-0	Most common beginner chord
F Major	1-1-2-3-3-1	Barre chord — needs practice!

Practice

Practice 1	Keyboard: Using the formula (Root + 4 half-tones + 3 more half-tones), build and play all 12 major chords. Start with C, then go through the 12 notes.

Practice 2	Keyboard: Play each major chord and hold for 4 beats. Go through all 12 in order. This is a great daily warm-up!
Practice 3	Guitar: Learn and practice E, A, D, G, C major chords. Switch between them slowly. Aim to switch in time to a metronome at 60 BPM.
Practice 4	Guitar: Practice switching from C to G, G to D, D to A, A to E. These are the most common chord changes in many songs!

Lesson 23: Formatting the Minor Chords

The Minor Chord Formula

A minor chord uses a very similar formula to a major chord, with ONE important difference: the middle note (the 3rd) is moved DOWN by one half-tone. This small change creates the whole sad, emotional sound of minor chords.

Minor Chord = Root + 3 half-tones up + 4 half-tones up (Root) (Minor 3rd) (Perfect 5th) Compare with Major: Root + 4 half-tones + 3 half-tones The 3rd and 4th numbers are SWAPPED!

Major vs Minor — Side by Side

Chord	Formula	Notes	Sound
C Major	C + 4H + 3H	C – E – G	Bright, happy
C Minor	C + 3H + 4H	C – Eb – G	Dark, sad
A Major	A + 4H + 3H	A – C# – E	Bright, happy
A Minor	A + 3H + 4H	A – C – E	Dark, sad
G Major	G + 4H + 3H	G – B – D	Bright, happy
G Minor	G + 3H + 4H	G – Bb – D	Dark, sad

All 12 Minor Chords

Chord	Notes
C Minor (Cm)	C – Eb – G
C# Minor (C#m)	C# – E – G#
D Minor (Dm)	D – F – A
D# Minor / Eb Minor	D# – F# – A# (or Eb – Gb – Bb)
E Minor (Em)	E – G – B
F Minor (Fm)	F – Ab – C
F# Minor (F#m)	F# – A – C#
G Minor (Gm)	G – Bb – D
G# Minor / Ab Minor	G# – B – D# (or Ab – B – Eb)
A Minor (Am)	A – C – E
A# Minor / Bb Minor	A# – C# – F (or Bb – Db – F)
B Minor (Bm)	B – D – F#

Practice

Practice 1	Keyboard: Play C major (C-E-G), then C minor (C-Eb-G). Just moving E down one key (to Eb) changes everything. Play them back and forth and hear the dramatic difference!
Practice 2	Using the minor formula (Root + 3H + 4H), build Am, Em, Dm, Gm, Bm chords on the keyboard. Hold each for 4 beats.
Practice 3	Guitar: Learn Am (x02210), Em (022000), Dm (xx0231). These are the 3 most important minor open chords. Practice switching between them.
Practice 4	Chord progression with minors: Play Am – F – C – G on keyboard or guitar. This is one of the most popular chord progressions in music (used in 'Numb' by Linkin Park, 'Clocks' by Coldplay, and many more).

Lesson 24: Finding Chords with the Help of Scales

Diatonic Chords — Chords That Belong to a Key

Diatonic chords are chords built using ONLY the notes from a specific scale. Every major scale produces 7 chords (one built on each degree of the scale). These 7 chords naturally work together because they all share the same family of notes.

The 7 Chords of C Major

Build a chord on each degree of C major by taking the 1st, 3rd, and 5th notes of the scale starting from each degree:

Degree	Chord Name	Notes	Type	Symbol
I	C Major	C – E – G	Major	C
II	D Minor	D – F – A	Minor	Dm
III	E Minor	E – G – B	Minor	Em
IV	F Major	F – A – C	Major	F
V	G Major	G – B – D	Major	G
VI	A Minor	A – C – E	Minor	Am
VII	B Diminished	B – D – F	Diminished	Bdim

The Universal Pattern — Major Scale Chord Types

This pattern of Major-Minor-Minor-Major-Major-Minor-Diminished is the SAME in every major key. Once you know this, you can find all 7 chords in any key!

Degrees I, IV, V = MAJOR chords Degrees II, III, VI = MINOR chords Degree VII = DIMINISHED chord

Example — Chords in G Major

G major scale: G-A-B-C-D-E-F# Apply the pattern: I=G Major, II=A Minor, III=B Minor, IV=C Major, V=D Major, VI=E Minor, VII=F# Diminished

Popular Chord Progressions Using This System

Progression	Degrees	C Major Example	Famous Songs
I-IV-V	1-4-5	C-F-G	Most blues and rock songs, '12-bar blues'
I-V-VI-IV	1-5-6-4	C-G-Am-F	'Let It Be', 'No Woman No Cry'
VI-IV-I-V	6-4-1-5	Am-F-C-G	'Someone Like You', many pop songs
I-IV-VI-V	1-4-6-5	C-F-Am-G	Many folk and country songs

Practice

Practice 1	Keyboard: Play all 7 chords of C major (C-Dm-Em-F-G-Am-Bdim). Hold each for 2 beats. Listen to how they all sound like they belong together.
Practice 2	Play the I-V-VI-IV progression in C major: C major (4 beats) → G major (4 beats) → A minor (4 beats) → F major (4 beats). Repeat 4 times. You're playing real music!
Practice 3	Find the 7 diatonic chords of G major using the formula. (Hint: G, Am, Bm, C, D, Em, F#dim).
Practice 4	Guitar: Practice switching between C-G-Am-F (I-V-VI-IV in C major). Use the metronome at 60 BPM, 4 beats per chord. Speed up only when smooth.

Lesson 25: Single Fingered Chords Position

What is Single Finger Mode?

Single finger chords (also called auto-chord or one-finger chords) is a feature on most electronic keyboards and arranger keyboards. When you press just ONE key in the left hand section, the keyboard automatically plays a full chord with bass notes. This is perfect for beginners who are still learning to use both hands together.

How Single Finger Mode Works

Press ONE white key	→ Plays a MAJOR chord on that note. Example: Press C = C major chord plays automatically.
Press ONE black key	→ Plays a MINOR chord. Example: Press the black key above D (D#) = D# minor chord.
Two-finger minor	→ Some keyboards: press root + one black key to get minor chord.
Two-finger 7th	→ Some keyboards: press root + one white key to the left to get a 7th chord.

■ Keyboard Note

Single finger mode is only available on arranger keyboards and digital pianos with auto-accompaniment features. Check your keyboard's manual for how to activate it. Look for a button labelled 'Single Finger', 'Auto Chord', or 'Fingered'. Single finger mode is a great learning tool, but always learn the proper full chord fingerings as well!

Finger Positions for Full Chord Playing

When playing chords manually (not using auto-chord), use the correct finger positions to make playing smooth and comfortable:

Chord	Left Hand	Right Hand (Root Position)
C Major (C-E-G)	Finger 5 on C, Finger 1 on G	Thumb(1) on C, Middle(3) on E, Pinky(5) on G
F Major (F-A-C)	Finger 5 on F, Finger 1 on C	Thumb(1) on F, Middle(3) on A, Pinky(5) on C
G Major (G-B-D)	Finger 5 on G, Finger 1 on D	Thumb(1) on G, Middle(3) on B, Pinky(5) on D
A Minor (A-C-E)	Finger 5 on A, Finger 1 on E	Thumb(1) on A, Middle(3) on C, Pinky(5) on E

Chord Inversions — Moving Chord Positions

A chord can be played in different **positions** (called inversions) by changing which note is at the bottom. This makes chord changes smoother because your fingers don't have to jump as far:

Position	Name	C Major Example	Use
C-E-G	Root Position	C at bottom	Starting position
E-G-C	1st Inversion	E at bottom	Smooth movement up
G-C-E	2nd Inversion	G at bottom	Smooth movement up more

Practice

Practice 1	Keyboard (Single Finger): Activate single finger chord mode. Press C with one left-hand finger while your right hand plays a simple melody (C-D-E-F-G). Hear how the full accompaniment plays automatically!
Practice 2	Keyboard: Practice the I-V-VI-IV progression (C-G-Am-F) using full chord finger positions. Hold each chord for 4 beats. Switch chords smoothly.
Practice 3	Practice C major chord in all 3 positions: Root (C-E-G), 1st Inversion (E-G-C), 2nd Inversion (G-C-E). Play them up and down like a pattern.
Practice 4	Guitar: Practice C, Am, F, G chord shapes in order. Set metronome to 50 BPM. Switch every 4 beats. Work up to 80 BPM over 2 weeks.

EXTRA LESSONS

These extra lessons go beyond the basics and add richness, creativity, and professional polish to your playing. They are suitable for students who have completed Lessons 1–25 and are ready to explore more exciting techniques.

Extra Lesson 1: Accompaniments

What is Accompaniment?

Accompaniment is the musical background that supports a melody or a singer. When you play chords with your left hand on keyboard while your right hand plays the melody, you are playing an accompaniment. On guitar, when you strum chords while someone sings, that is also accompaniment.

Types of Accompaniment Patterns

Pattern	Description	Best Style
Block Chords	Play all notes of the chord at the same time on every beat	Hymns, gospel, simple songs
Broken Chords -Arpeggio	Play chord notes one at a time in a rolling pattern (1-3-5-3-1-3-5...)	Ballads, classical, romantic songs
Bass-Chord Pattern	Left hand alternates: bass note, then chord, REPEAT	Pop, waltz, country
Alberti Bass	Left hand pattern: low-high-mid-high (C-G-E-G) repeated	Classical, elegant pieces
Stride Piano	Left hand jumps: bass note on beat 1, chord on beat 2 (stride)	Jazz, ragtime, old-time music
Guitar Strumming	Strum chords in patterns: D DU UDU, etc.	Pop, rock, folk, country
Guitar Fingerpicking	Pluck bass string with thumb, melody strings with fingers	Folk, classical guitar, ballads

Building an Accompaniment — Step by Step

- Step 1: Know the chords of the song (use the scale chord system from Lesson 24).
- Step 2: Choose an accompaniment pattern that fits the style (block chords for gospel, arpeggio for ballad, strum for pop).
- Step 3: Practice the accompaniment pattern on its own with a metronome.
- Step 4: Add the melody (right hand on keyboard, or voice).
- Step 5: Put both together slowly, then speed up.

Practice

Practice 1	Keyboard: Play C-F-G-C chord progression using BLOCK CHORDS (all notes together) on beats 1-2-3-4. Repeat 4 times.

Practice 2	Keyboard: Play the same progression using BROKEN CHORDS. For C major, play: C (beat 1), E (beat 2), G (beat 3), E (beat 4). Do this for each chord.
Practice 3	Guitar: Practice the strum pattern: Down-Down-Up-Down-Up (D-D-U-D-U) on a G chord. This is used in hundreds of pop songs!
Practice 4	Guitar Fingerpicking: Use thumb for string 6, index for string 3, middle for string 2, ring for string 1. On G chord, play: thumb-index-middle-ring pattern repeatedly.

Extra Lesson 2: Octaves (Advanced Playing)

Playing Octaves as a Technique

In Lesson 4, we learned what an octave IS. In this lesson, we learn how to USE octaves as a playing technique to add power and richness to your music. Playing octaves means playing the same note simultaneously in two different octaves — usually with the thumb and pinky of one hand.

Octave Playing on Keyboard

To play an octave on keyboard: press a note with your THUMB (finger 1) and the SAME note one octave higher with your PINKY (finger 5). The distance is always 8 white keys (12 half-tones). Hold both down together — the sound is strong and full.

Octave Span: Thumb on note X → Pinky on same note X, 8 white keys to the right

Octave Melody — Playing Melody in Octaves

One of the most powerful keyboard techniques is playing the melody in OCTAVES with the right hand. This means every melody note is doubled one octave below, giving it a huge, grand sound. This technique is used in classical music, gospel, and dramatic pop/film music.

> Keyboard: Play each melody note with thumb + pinky together (octave apart). Your hand should form a 'C shape' reaching across 8 white keys.

Octave Playing on Guitar

On guitar, octave playing means finding the same note on two different strings simultaneously. Use the octave formula from Lesson 4 (2 strings thinner + 2 frets higher). A clean technique is to mute the string between the two octave notes with the side of your index finger.

Practice

Practice 1	Keyboard: Play C in the middle octave with thumb, and C one octave higher with pinky. Hold for 4 beats. Then move the same shape to D (one step higher). Practice going up the scale: C-D-E-F-G in octaves.
Practice 2	Keyboard: Play 'Mary Had a Little Lamb' melody using octaves (every note doubled). It will sound much bigger and more dramatic!
Practice 3	Guitar: Find the octave of any note using the formula. Play A on string 5 fret 0 (open). Its octave is on string 3 fret 2. Play both together while muting string 4.

Practice 4	Speed drill: Play a simple 5-note scale using octaves on keyboard at slow speed. Increase by 5 BPM each time you play it correctly 3 times in a row.

Extra Lesson 3: Split

What is a Split on Keyboard?

Split is a feature on electronic keyboards that divides the keyboard into two zones — a LEFT ZONE and a RIGHT ZONE — each playing a completely different instrument sound. For example, your left hand can play a bass guitar sound while your right hand plays a piano sound.

How Split Works

Left Zone	Usually plays a bass or pad sound (strings, organ, bass guitar).
Right Zone	Usually plays the main melody instrument (piano, flute, violin).
Split Point	The key on the keyboard where the two zones meet. You can usually change this point.
Common Split	Split at Middle C — left plays bass, right plays melody.

How to Set Up Split on Your Keyboard

- Step 1: Press the 'Split' button on your keyboard (check your manual — it may say 'Layer/Split' or 'Dual/Split').
- Step 2: Choose the voice (instrument sound) for the LEFT zone.
- Step 3: Choose the voice for the RIGHT zone.
- Step 4: Set the split point (usually done by pressing a key after activating split).
- Step 5: Play! Left hand plays left zone sound, right hand plays right zone sound.

Creative Uses of Split

Left Zone Sound	Right Zone Sound	Result
String Bass	Piano	Sounds like a full band — bass + piano
Acoustic Bass	Flute	Orchestral, classical feel
Organ bass	Gospel Piano	Full gospel/church sound
Electric Bass	Synth Lead	Modern electronic music feel
Drum Beat (if available)	Any melody	Built-in rhythm section + melody

Practice

Practice 1	Set up split on your keyboard with String Bass on the left and Piano on the right. Play bass notes (C-G-F-G) with left hand and a simple melody with right hand.

Practice 2	Experiment with different split combinations. Try Organ (left) + Choir (right). Play a hymn chord progression and hear the rich sound.
Practice 3	Find the split point on your keyboard. Move it higher (to give more range to the bass) or lower. How does this change the feeling of your playing?
Practice 4	Compose a short 4-bar piece using split. Write down: what chords you played in the left, and what melody you played in the right. This is your first keyboard composition!

Extra Lesson 4: Dual Tones

What are Dual Tones?

Dual Tones (also called Layer Mode, Dual Voice, or Layer on some keyboards) means TWO different instrument sounds play at the same time when you press any key. Unlike Split (where each hand plays a different sound), Dual Tones makes BOTH sounds happen on EVERY note you play.

Split vs Dual Tones — The Key Difference

Feature	Split	Dual Tones
How it works	LEFT side = Sound 1, RIGHT side = Sound 2	Every key = Sound 1 + Sound 2 together
Number of sounds	2 sounds, but separate zones	2 sounds layered on every key
Best for	Playing bass + melody with two hands	Creating rich, thick textures with any note
Example	Bass left + Piano right	Piano + Strings on every key together

Classic Dual Tone Combinations

Piano + Strings	The most popular dual tone — piano gives clarity, strings add warmth and emotion. Perfect for ballads.
Piano + Choir	Adds a heavenly vocal texture. Beautiful for worship music and emotional pieces.
Electric Piano + Pad	Modern, atmospheric sound. Great for contemporary Christian music and pop.
Guitar + Strings	Warm and rich. Good for folk-style arrangements.
Flute + Harp	Light, angelic sound. Suits children's songs and gentle melodies.
Organ + Choir	Full gospel sound. Very powerful for church music.

Practice

Practice 1	Set up Dual Tones with Piano + Strings. Play a slow melody (like 'Amazing Grace'). Notice how the strings add warmth and fullness to every note.
Practice 2	Try Piano + Choir dual tones. Play any chord progression slowly. Listen to how the choir sound makes it feel like a big hall or church.

Practice 3	Experiment with 3 different dual tone combinations. For each one, play the same short melody and write down one word to describe how it sounds.
Practice 4	Creative project: Choose your favourite dual tone combination and play a complete simple song from beginning to end using that sound. Perform it for a friend or family member!

Extra Lesson 5: Pitch Bend

What is Pitch Bend?

Pitch Bend is a technique that smoothly raises or lowers the pitch of a note WHILE it is playing, creating a sliding, expressive sound. It is one of the most expressive techniques in music — it is what makes the guitar 'cry', the saxophone 'wail', and electronic music sound fluid and alive.

Pitch Bend on Keyboard

On electronic keyboards, pitch bend is controlled by the **Pitch Bend Wheel** — a wheel or lever on the left side of the keyboard. When you roll it UP, the note gets higher. When you roll it DOWN, the note gets lower. When you release it, it snaps back to the original pitch.

Bend Up	Roll the pitch bend wheel upward while holding a note. The pitch rises smoothly.
Bend Down	Roll the pitch bend wheel downward while holding a note. The pitch drops smoothly.
Vibrato Effect	Quickly roll the wheel up and down in small amounts — creates a wobbling vibrato effect.
Half-Step Bend	Roll just enough to raise by exactly one half-tone — sounds like a string bend.
Full Bend	Roll all the way up — raises pitch by 2 half-tones (a full tone).

Pitch Bend on Guitar

On guitar, pitch bend (also called **string bending**) is done by pressing a string and PUSHING it sideways (upward or downward) across the fretboard. This stretches the string and raises the pitch. String bending is one of the most important techniques in rock, blues, and pop guitar.

Type of Bend	How to Do It	Sound
Half-Step Bend	Push string up to raise pitch by 1 half-tone	Subtle, emotional slide
Whole-Step Bend	Push string up to raise pitch by 2 half-tones	Classic rock/blues bend - very expressive
Bend and Release	Bend up, then slowly release back to original pitch	Crying, falling sound
Pre-Bend	Bend before picking, then pick and release down	Opposite of normal — dramatic effect
Vibrato (guitar)	After bending, shake the string up and down rapidly	Sustaining, singing quality

Why Pitch Bend Matters

Pitch bend makes music sound human and emotional. Perfectly in-tune notes can sometimes sound mechanical. Adding a slight bend, a vibrato, or a slide makes the music breathe and feel

alive. Listen to any great blues guitarist or expressive vocalist — they all use pitch variation constantly to communicate deep emotion.

■ Guitar Technique Tip

String bending on guitar requires strong fingers. Build up slowly — start with bends on the thinnest strings (strings 1 and 2), as they require less force. Always use 3 fingers to push the string for more control (ring finger on the note, middle and index fingers supporting behind it).

Practice

Practice 1	Keyboard: Set your voice to 'Electric Guitar' or 'Saxophone'. Play a long note and slowly roll the pitch bend wheel up. Then slowly release it back. Do this with many different notes.
Practice 2	Keyboard: Play a melody (like a blues scale: C-Eb-F-F#-G-Bb-C). After each note, give a small upward pitch bend. This immediately sounds more expressive and bluesy!
Practice 3	Guitar: On the 3rd string, 7th fret (note B), pick the note and push the string upward (toward the ceiling). Aim to raise the pitch to C (one half-tone). Do this 20 times until it feels natural.
Practice 4	Guitar: Practice a full-step bend: on the 2nd string, 8th fret (C), bend up to D. This is the most common blues bend. Practice until the bent note is perfectly in tune.

CONGRATULATIONS! ■

You have completed Grade 1 — See and Play!

By finishing this book, you have learned the foundations of music. You now understand Melody, Rhythm, Scales, Chords, and many exciting extra techniques. This is a huge achievement — be proud of yourself!

What You Learned	Key Skills
■ Melody Concept	Notes, tones, sharps/flats, octaves, 12 notes
■ Rhythm Concept	Beats, timing, style, tempo, metronome, rolls
■ Scales Concept	Major & minor scales, transposing, key finding
■ Chords Concept	Major & minor chords, progressions, inversions
■ Extra Techniques	Accompaniment, octaves, split, dual tones, pitch bend

■ Final Words from Your Teacher

Music is a lifelong journey. Every great musician started exactly where you are right now. Keep practising every day — even 15 minutes of focused practice is better than 2 hours of unfocused playing. Be patient with yourself. Celebrate every small victory. And most importantly — ENJOY the music you make!

Next Steps: Grade 2 will build on everything you learned here. You will explore more complex chords, scales in all 12 keys, song arrangements, and advanced rhythm patterns. Keep practicing and keep growing!

Keep Playing. Keep Growing. Keep Loving Music! ■